SOP-GOV-001 · Board reading room membership

SOP GOV-001 | Status draft | Changed 2026-11-01 | For Officers and the steward

Department: GOV · **ID:** 001 · **Status:** draft (approved when tagged) · **Owner:** the organisation's officers; the steward executes · **Last changed:** 2026-11-01

> ***Filled in for Psanctuary Church (2026-10-31); not yet run.*** *The church has no* `board` *team yet, so steps 1–3 below are still to do, each on the officers' word. Placeholders keep their names in the steps so the procedure reads the same in every organisation; this table says what they are here.*
>
> | *Placeholder* | *Means* | *Psanctuary Church* |
> |---|---|---|
> | `<org>` | *the organisation's GitHub login* | `psanctuarychurch` |
> | `<board-team>` | *the closed team that holds the Board* | `board` *(to be created in step 1)* |
> | `<committee-repos>` | *the private repositories the Board reads, space-separated* | `proposals` *(the church has no committee repositories yet; whether the Board also reads* `legal` *is the officers' decision, and it is added here only on their word)* |
> | `<board-inbox>` | *the page the Board opens first* | *the* `proposals` *README* |
> | `<officers>` | *who names Board members (by role)* | *the church's co-founders* |
>
> *The members' reading room is a separate door with its own team (* `readers` *, Read on* `reading-room` *only; SOP-IT-002). A Board member who should also read the room is added to both teams.*

Purpose

How a member of `<org>` 's board of directors is given **Read** on `<committee-repos>` through a closed GitHub team, how they accept, and how the steward verifies it from the member's side.

Scope

`<org>` , for every board member and every committee repository the Board should read. **GitHub membership is not Board membership:** `<officers>` decide who sits on the Board; this procedure only opens the door for the people they name. Write access, treasury and credentials are out of scope.

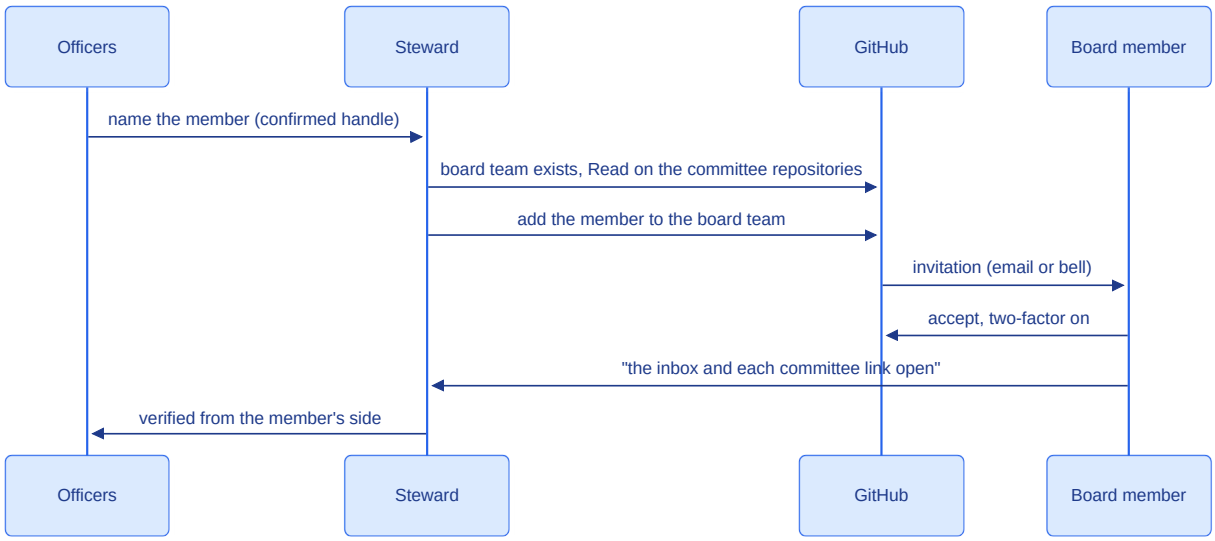
Roles

Role	Does
`<officers>`	name the Board members, by confirmed GitHub handle
Steward (an organisation owner, or a helper preparing commands for one)	creates `<board-team>` once, grants Read, adds members, verifies
Member	accepts, reads, reports a link that does not open

Prerequisites

The committee repositories exist under `<org>` (not under a personal account: a personal private repository cannot give anyone read-only access, SOP-IT-002). The steward is an owner of `<org>`, or holds the commands for one.

Who does what, in order



With the organisation's base permission at **No permission** (SOP-GOV-002), this team is the only way a member reads the committee repositories, so the team page is the true list of who can.

Steps: steward

1. Create the closed team once. *You should see:* the team page; `repos_count 0`, `members_count 1` at creation is normal (the creator).

   ```
   gh api -X POST orgs/<org>/teams -f name=<board-team> -f privacy=closed
   ```

2. Grant Read on each committee repository.

   ```
   for r in <committee-repos>; do gh api -X PUT orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/repos/<org>/$r -f permission=pull; done
   ```

   You should see: `gh api orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/repos --jq '.[].name'` lists each one.

3. Add each Board member by their confirmed handle, on an officer's yes.

   ```
   gh api -X PUT orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/memberships/<login>
   ```

   You should see: `state: pending` until they accept, then `active`.

4. Verify as a member would: ask one member to open `<board-inbox>` and one link per committee from their own account. An owner's successful read proves nothing about a member's access.

Steps: member

1. Give the steward your GitHub handle privately.
2. Accept the organisation invitation (email, or the bell icon on GitHub); turn on two-factor authentication.
3. Accept the team assignment if GitHub asks.
4. Open `<board-inbox>` and one link from each committee; if one does not open, report the address and the error, never a credential.
5. Read in the browser. Bringing an AI helper is a separate request (SOP-IT-002).

Verification

`gh api --paginate orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/members --jq '.[].login'` lists every named Board member; `gh api orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/invitations` is empty; each member has opened a committee link from their own account.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Inbox links open for the owner but not for members	repositories not attached to the team, or members still pending	steps 2–3; wait for acceptance
A member sees more than Read	another team, or the organisation's base permission, grants it	inspect inherited roles under the organisation's settings; set the base permission to *No permission* (SOP-GOV-002 says why and how)
A committee repository is missing from the team	it was created after step 2	run step 2 again for that repository; add it to `<committee-repos>` here
A member left the Board	the officers said so	`gh api -X DELETE orgs/<org>/teams/<board-team>/memberships/<login>`; their organisation membership is a separate decision

Worked example: Psychedelics in Recovery® (live state, read 2026-10-30)

> *This is PIR's first run, kept as the example. It is **not** a template default; other organisations fill in their own.*

- `<org>` = `psychedelicsinrecovery`, `<board-team>` = `board`, `<committee-repos>` = `tech-committee public-relations literature-committee`, `<board-inbox>` = the `board` repository's README.
- Read on 2026-10-30: the three committee repositories at Read on the `board` team, one active member, no pending invitations.
- The access guide's PIR insert (`my-template/org-onboarding/ACCESS-AND-PATS.md`) and the PIR desk proposal 002 *The Board reading room* are the background.

Related

- SOP-IT-002 (reading room and helper access; the generic reading-room route), SOP-GOV-002 (teams and base permission)
- `my-template/org-onboarding/ACCESS-AND-PATS.md`
- Proposal: PIR desk 002 *The Board reading room* (the first organisation to run this)

Change log

Date	Change	By
2026-10-30	Drafted; PIR grants verified by read the same day (three repositories at Read, one member, no pending invitations)	Alfred
2026-10-31	Generalised for every organisation's board: placeholders, a fill-in box, PIR's live state moved to a marked worked example; member removal added	Alfred
2026-11-01	Lucid pass: Lucide icons, the order of hands in Mermaid; base permission none (SOP-GOV-002) makes the board team the true list	Alfred
2026-10-31	Filled in for Psanctuary Church: `psanctuarychurch`, a `board` team still to create, `proposals` as the first repository the Board reads; not yet run	Alfred
2026-11-01	Psanctuary Church: the lucid pass taken in; the church's base permission is none (set 2026-11-01), so the `board` team, once created, is the true list	Alfred